CSE0001: Digital Literacy Project Report

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Course Code: CSE0001

Date: March 25, 2026

Introduction

This project was completed as part of the Digital Literacy course requirements for the Student Digital Ambassador role. The primary objective was to build a comprehensive Digital Literacy Portfolio that demonstrates proficiency in professional online presence, digital security, and collaborative tools. This report documents the completion of five specialized tasks—ranging from creating awareness infographics to researching cybercrime prevention—all organized within a professional GitHub repository.

Task 1 Write-up: Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For this task, I designed a one-page visual resource using **Canva** to help my peers understand the pillars of digital literacy. My infographic focuses on three key areas: professional online presence, safe internet practices, and essential digital tools for engineering students. One interesting aspect of this task was learning how to simplify complex information into a visually engaging format. The most difficult part was choosing which information to prioritize to ensure the design remained clean and readable.

Task 2 Write-up: Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

I established professional profiles on **GitHub**, **LinkedIn**, and **Stack Overflow**. LinkedIn serves as my primary professional network for connecting with the academic community, while GitHub acts as a technical gallery for my coding projects. On Stack Overflow, I can engage with developer Q&A to solve technical hurdles. Over the next four years, I plan to use these platforms as a "living resume" by consistently updating my skills, projects, and certifications to remain competitive for internships and future career opportunities.

Task 3 Write-up: Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

I utilized **HackerRank** to complete a beginner-level coding challenge, which helped me familiarize myself with competitive programming environments. Additionally, I built a "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" using **Google Forms**, linked to a **Google Sheet** for response tracking. These tools will be vital in my academic career for collecting data during research and practicing core programming logic. Mastering cloud collaboration through Google Workspace ensures I can work effectively in team-based engineering projects.

Task 4 Write-up: Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

Digital communication is a core skill for any professional. I drafted two professional emails: one requesting a deadline extension from a professor and another expressing interest in an internship opportunity. Through this, I learned that clear subject lines and a respectful tone are more important than the length of the message. A common communication pitfall is the lack of clarity in subject lines, which often leads to missed opportunities; I now understand that a structured approach prevents such professional misunderstandings.

Task 5 Write-up: Cybercrime Awareness & Prevention

While researching **Phishing** and **UPI Fraud**, I was most surprised by how sophisticated social engineering tactics have become, especially targeting college students in India. One habit I will personally change is enabling two-factor authentication (2FA) on all financial accounts and being more cautious of unsolicited links. Understanding that there is a dedicated National Cyber Crime Portal (1930) provides me with the confidence to assist my peers should they encounter online threats.

Conclusion

This project has significantly enhanced my digital literacy by forcing me to move beyond being a passive user of technology to becoming an active, professional participant in the digital world. I have learned how to manage my digital footprint, communicate professionally, and protect myself against common online risks. These skills form the foundation of my professional identity as a Computer Science student at VIT Bhopal.

References

* GitHub (github.com)

* LinkedIn (linkedin.com)

* Canva (canva.com)

* HackerRank (hackerrank.com)

* National Cyber Crime Portal (cybercrime.gov.in)